

Behind the publication process

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Refresher 2022



- Why publish?
- Deciding where to publish
- What happens when you click submit?
- How to improve your chances of success
- Discussion

Rebecca

- Editor-in-Chief of the Journal of Statistical Software
- Associate Editor of Biometrics
- Associate Editor of Data Science in Science (new journal)

Jan

- Subject Editor (Algebra), Glasgow Mathematical Journal

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- To create scholarly discussion
- To increase your reputation
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- Because our research contracts say we need to

- All subjects have journal rankings

<https://www.scimagojr.com/journalrank.php>

- Don't just go by rankings, talk to others about which journals they respect/read
- Look at where similar papers in your field have been published
- Ask colleagues for advice on where to submit
- Don't just aim to the top journal, aim where you think it will fit
- Look at the list of associate editors, is there anyone from your field listed?

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2. Editor-in-chief checks remit and fit ... reject

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9. Invited to revise paper based on reviewers comments
10. Authors submit a revision and rebuttal letter

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9. **Paper accepted**

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9. **Paper accepted**
10. Paper passes to post-processing
11. Editorial office formats the paper
12. Authors check the formatted paper
13. Paper queued for publishing in a future issue
14. Paper (finally!) published

- Pass your paper to trusted colleagues to read before submitting
 - Act on their feedback!
- Leave the paper for a week or two and come back to it with fresh eyes
- Try to read your paper like a reviewer - look for the holes
- Try to think about what could make your paper better
 - Then think about whether it is worth doing it!
- Get to know discipline norms on the importance of cover letters

- Read the journal remit and think if it is an appropriate outlet
- Read recent papers in the journal and think whether your work fits the style
- If you know any of the editors or people who have published there before, ask them if they think your paper would be a good fit
- Read the instructions for authors . . . and follow them
- Follow page limits
- Include everything the journal asks you to

Strategies people use to prioritize writing:

- Book research/writing meetings in their diary
- Join a writing group to keep accountable
- Work from home to avoid distractions (pre-pandemic!!!!)
- Have “meeting days” to reduce distractions on other days
- Get a grant to get buyout from other duties

Every time you say yes to something other than your research, you are saying no to your research.

Over to you.